

Implementing User Authentication Mechanism

In this exercise, you'll create a simple registration and login system using the php, mysql and sessions. This exercise is comprised of two parts: in the first part we'll create a user registration form, and in the second part we'll create a login form, as well as a welcome page and a logout script.

Building the Registration System

Step 1: Creating the Database Table

In this section you'll build a registration system that allows users to create a new account by filling out a web form. But, first you need to create a table that will hold all the user data.

Users	
id	int not null primary key auto_increment
username	varchar(50) not null unique
password	varchar(25) not null
created_at	DATETIME default CURRENT_TIMESTAMP

Step 2: Creating the Config File

After creating the table, you need create a file named config.php in order to connect to the MySQL database server.

Step 3: Creating the Registration Form

You'll create another PHP file "register.php" that allows user to register themselves via a web form.

This script will also generate errors if a user tries to submit the form without entering any value, or if username entered by the user is already taken by another user.

Sign Up

Please fill this form to create an account.

Username

Password

Confirm Password

Submit

Reset

Already have an account? [Login here.](#)

Building the Login System

In this section we'll create a login form where user can enter their username and password. When user submit the form these inputs will be verified against the credentials stored in the database, if the username and password match, the user is authorized and granted access to the welcome page, otherwise the login attempt will be rejected.

Step 1: Creating the Login Form

You'll create a file named "login.php" to enter your username and password. In this file, you need use sessions to store data.

Login

Please fill in your credentials to login.

Username

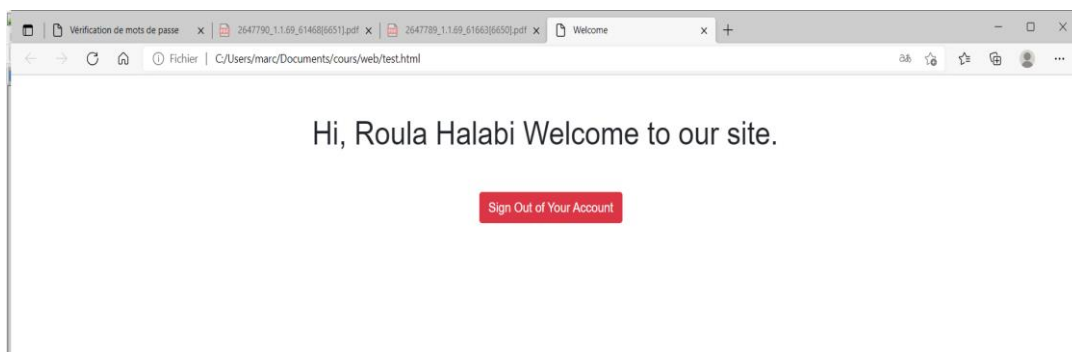
Password

Login

Don't have an account? [Sign up now.](#)

Step 2: Creating the Welcome Page

You'll create the file `welcome.php` where user is redirected after successful login. If the user clicks on the link sign out of your account, he is redirected to the `logout.php` page. Here again, you need use **sessions**.



Step 3: Creating the Logout Script

Now, you'll create a "`logout.php`" file. When the user clicks on the log out or sign out link, the script inside this file **destroys the session** and redirect the user back to the login page.